

The Voice

August 2024

A NEWSLETTER FOR MEMBERS AND FRIENDS OF FIRST EVANGELICAL LUTHERAN CHURCH

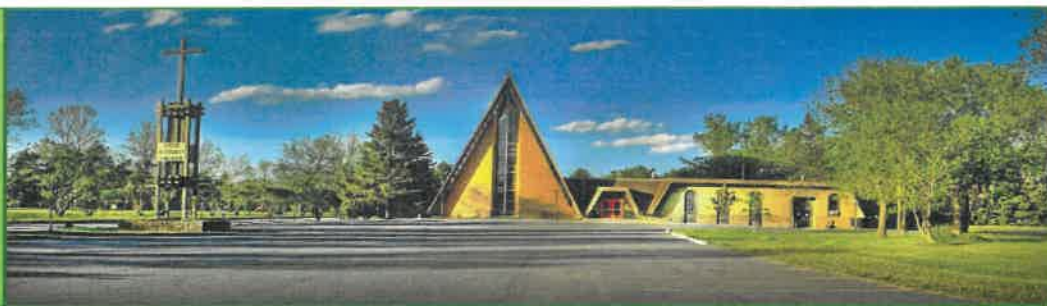
A Congregation of the
Northeastern
Minnesota Synod, ELCA



Music recommendation,
Page 6



What's Up, Youth?
Pages 8 and 9



Hear ye! Hear ye! First has entered contract with Fort Frances' Zion Lutheran

Zion Lutheran in Fort Frances and First Lutheran will officially be in a contract relationship beginning on August 18th. The council has shared that we have been working on this for a while, and it looks like it's happening!

This means Pastor Christie will be preaching and leading worship at both locations starting on this date.

This also means service times will be changing--for them, a lot; for us, a little.

Zion will worship at 9 a.m., and First will worship at 11 a.m., which will allow time for Pastor Christie to travel back from Canada in a timely manner.



ELCAYG a hit for nine

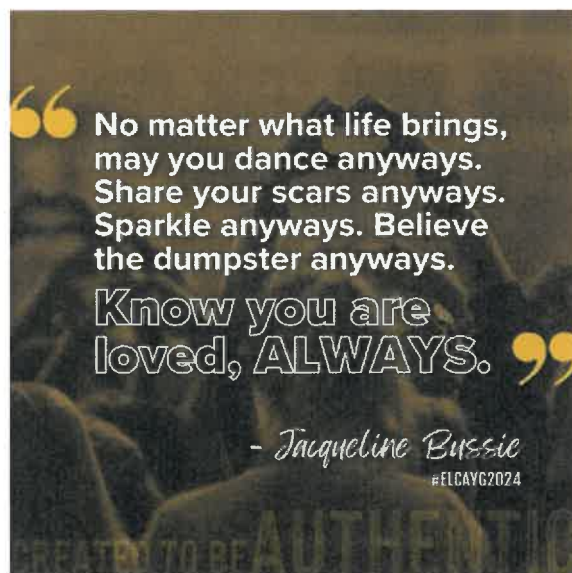
Nine community members traveled to the ELCA Youth Gathering in New Orleans this July.

They made new friends, discovered new ideas, ate great food, slept very little, and helped in the community.

In the group were Pastor Christie, Steve Saari, Becca Schultz, Nick Schultz, Lachlan Reiners, Max Youso, Lauren Basaraba, Grace Froemke, and Linnaea Yount.



From the Pastor's Desk



It has been four days since we returned from a week at the ELCA Youth Gathering as I write this. As you may know six youth and three adults (including myself) traveled to New Orleans for a week of learning, growing and fun. As I now reflect on that week, I can say it was that and so much more.

A lively and excited group of 16,700 of us spent every hour of every day immersed in new things. We sang songs, did acts of service, worshiped, walked in accompaniment with new people, met new friends, listened to speakers, shared together new ideas, and traveled throughout the city meeting the people of New Orleans to hear their stories. We were given a picture of the *kin-dom* of God through the wisdom of elders and of youth who told us why New Orleans has been and will always be their home. As one woman (our uber driver) shared with us: “I love New Orleans because it just doesn’t matter who you are, you are accepted here—gender, race, class, who you love, all of it is welcome here and I love that about this place.”

This too was our experience, which in some ways was a surprise for some of our group. As one of our students shared, “I’ve never been in a place where I can just be who I am, and it doesn’t matter—I don’t have to put on a mask or pretend—I can just be.”

Our students will be sharing about their experiences in a special “celebration” in September and will give an even larger picture of what our time there was like. I look forward to hearing and showing what this experience was like through their eyes.

In the meantime, I cannot thank you all enough for your love, care, and support both spiritual and financial so that this trip could be a reality. It was a joy to represent First Lutheran Church International Falls both on the Synod Journey and at the Gathering, and we look forward to all the beauty that will surely ripple forth from what has been learned and gained.

I pray you all are well and that your summer is one of peace and relaxation as well as perhaps learning and new growth.

Peace be with you.

Your friend in Christ, Pastor Christie

First Evangelical Lutheran Church Council Meeting

June 20th, 2024

Present: President Brian Briggs, Secretary Carol Bass, Pastor Christie Manisto, Treasurer Brad Ettestad, Building & Grounds Lloyd Skogstad, Fellowship Cynthia Warren, Outreach Brenda Bertilson, Worship & Music Rachel Hasbargen-Glowack

Absent: Discipleship BettyJeanne Henrickson

Meeting called to order by President Brian Briggs at 5:00 PM

Opening Devotional: Cynthia Warren Good Morning God "Jesus the Word, the Light".

Next Month: Carol Bass

Additions to Agenda: None

Approve minutes of May 2024:

Motion: To approve the minutes of May 2024 as presented.

Made by: Cynthia Warren

Seconded by: Brad Ettestad Passed

Approve Financial Reports of May 2024: We are currently running a deficit of \$12,000 (YTD). Estimated that this will grow to between \$18,000-\$25,000 by the end of the year. We are drawing on our reserves and need to find ways to increase our income.

Motion: to accept financial reports as presented for May 2024.

Made by: Lloyd Skogstad

Seconded by: Cynthia Warren Passed

May 20-June 20 Pastor Christie's report

Pastoral acts

☐ Led worship

☐ visitation and pastoral care phone calls, meetings and cards with members

☐ planning for 2 funerals at the end of June

☐ started 8 AM "Sunrise services" through Aug 18th for those who have a busy summer.

Community

☐ Continuing to serve as part of the Rotary welcoming community team. Meetings concluded in June.

☐ Continuing as Part of an ELCA cohort group meeting on Thursdays each week for 1 hour.

☐ Keynote speaker for the Interfaith committee for migrant justice (ICMJ) at St. Scholastica (part of NEMN synod and Duluth area churches)

☐ 1 meeting for the Kooch board of aging

Youth

☐ Met with planning team for confirmation/youth programming 2024-25. Agreed on curriculum and events.

☐ VBS program June 10-14

☐ VBS worship service

☐ Met with Steve Early—planning an intergenerational canoe trip for Aug 17th

Synod

☐ Mutual ministry meeting in Cook

☐ Led session on Lutheran theology 101 at Camp Vermilion for staff training

Admin

☐ Committee meetings (finance, building and grounds, care corps etc.)

☐ Met with Rachel Berry to plan some congregational events with youth at Rainy River (per our discussion at council retreat).

Personal

Headed to grandma's marathon to cheer Sunday on June 23rd

Upcoming

☐ Gloria Anderson's funeral Friday June 28th at 11am

☐ Jerry Streiff's funeral Saturday June 29th at 11am; graveside to follow at 3pm.

☐ Youth Gathering! July 14-20.

Committee Reports:

a. President – Many thanks to the VBS staff and the 23 kids who attended. Great time!

b. Vice-President – Office vacant

c. Service/Outreach: 4 volunteers at Café, 3 cards sent to ill/shut ins.

3 prayer requests initiated. Café date falls on July 4th so no need for volunteers that month.

Went through Helping Hands Food Pantry and removed some dated items. Thinking of some type of food-related project for God's Work Our Hands in September. Also, a food drive in the Fall.

d. Discipleship – Absent. No report

e. Fellowship – Provided snacks for Vacation Bible School and organized food for Work Day.

Office Hours:

Monday—Thursday

10 a.m. – 2 p.m.

Friday

9 a.m. to noon

218-283-2208

www.firstlutheranifalls.org

firstlutheranifalls@gmail.com

Council (continued from page 3)

f. Building and Grounds - met Wednesday June 19th. Pastor Christie, Steve Lindberg and Lloyd Skogstad. The primary purpose of the meeting was to discuss the insurance policy for the upcoming year. The premium had gone down but the deductible had increased tenfold. I met with Chad Belanger on Thursday to discuss options. Our liability insurance is about the same with zero deductible, but the building is \$25000 deductible and wind and hail has increased to 5% of the building value which is around 3.1 million. Which means a \$150,000 deductible. This also is not a guarantee of complete roof replacement. Deductible for fire, smoke, water damage is \$25,000. The discussion was that the \$150,000 was too much for too little payback but that we could put \$5,000 in dedicated fund each year for 5 years to cover the \$25,000 deductible. This will be put on the agenda for next council meeting.

Other business that was discussed:

Workday accomplishments -Thank you to everyone who worked so hard, both before the workday and on it. A lot was accomplished.

Summer projects – Nothing major, mostly some painting and cleaning, washing windows.

Lawn mowing - Emmett Olson will mow lawn each Saturday without charge.

Second pull down ladder replacement

Canoe trailer roadworthiness – In preparation for upcoming canoe trips, Lloyd will check wiring on trailer and redo as needed.

g. Finance: Nothing further

h. Worship and Music – no report.

Old Business:

a. Zion Ft Frances Covenant – A letter has been sent to Bishop Amy regarding the email from Ft Frances wondering if we would have a tax liability. This will be investigated. Discussion of rate structure followed. Should there be a base rate then addition for hours served?

Or different structure? Brad will work up several possibilities to present. A review at the end of the year can make needed changes.

Projected hrs. to start 6-8 per week. If Pastor has vacation days, Zion will be responsible to find pulpit supply for their church, and we will do the same for ours. Brad will do a rough draft for both a base rate and fluctuating rate to give to Zion at the next joint meeting. He will have something ready to show First council by Sunday (7th).

b, FYI – New CD begins June 24th for 7 mos. at 5.05% interest.

New Business:

a. – Heating/Cooling Issues – It was mentioned that it was very cold during Vacation Bible School (downstairs) . Cold air blowing from the vent by door. Wondered if this could be regulated

when basement is being used. One system heats in winter and cools in summer.

Blowers are on all the time. Temperature in office is 72 degrees for comfort of office staff/Pastor. If known ahead of time temperature could set to 68 degrees in basement for comfort. Asked if big vent could be shut down when basement is being used. This will be investigated.

b. Facility Use Agreement – The portion that states that no alcohol will be allowed at functions within the church will be amended to unless approved by church council.

Motion: That the Facility Use Agreement be amended to say" that no alcohol will be served at any functions within in the church unless approved by church council".

Made by: Brad Ettestad

Seconded by: Lloyd Skogstad

Passed

c. Resignation of Office Administrator – Kris Jackson has submitted her resignation from office staff, effective September 1st .

Motion: That the resignation of Kris Jackson as office staff be accepted and many thanks to her for her excellent service in that role.

Made by: Brad Ettestad

Seconded by: Cynthia Warren

Passed

Further discussed that a letter will be sent to Kris accepting her resignation and thanking her for her service. The Executive Committee will see to this.

Motion: That the Executive Committee performs the process of filling the position of office secretary.

Made by: Brad Ettestad

Seconded by: Lloyd Skogstad

Passed

Brian will ask Kris if she would be agreeable to have cake and coffee in her honor before she leaves her position and speak with her to the possibilities for volunteer positions, which she has said is of interest. Other: Council agreed that as several meetings are to be held in July with Ft Frances concerning the covenant and there being no pressing business, that there will not be an Executive nor Council meeting that month.

Adjourn at 7:08 PM

Respectfully submitted by: Carol Bass, Secretary

Next Executive Committee Meeting: August 13th , 2024, at 5 PM

Next council meeting: August 15th, 2024, at 5 PM



Shop for school kit needs

The FLW will be preparing school kits again this year for Lutheran World Relief. It may seem out of place to be thinking of school supplies at this time of year, but the best sales of these items are usually in August.

Supplies needed are 70-count notebooks, 24-count crayons, blue or black pens, pencil sharpeners, and blunt or semi-blunt edged scissors. When shopping, please consider picking up a few extras for these kits.



Potluck planned for August meeting, all are invited

FELC Women—July 8, 2024 minutes

The meeting opened with Brenda Bertilson reading “Embrace the Joy in the Rhythm of your Everyday Life” based on Matthew 19:14.

Mission and purpose statements were read.

Minutes from the previous meeting were read and approved.

Correspondence: Two thank you cards were received from the families of recent funerals.

Treasurer’s report was reviewed and approved.

The Fall Gathering is September 25, in Aurora, MN. Anyone interested in going, please contact the church office or Brenda Bertilson at 285-9366.

The Crazy Days Bake Sale will be July 31st

from 10 a.m. to 1 p.m. Baked goodies are needed. The church will be open July 30th from 9 a.m. to 3 p.m. for drop offs. Help is needed for setup and pricing. Flyers are being distributed.

Twelve six-foot rectangular tablecloths have been ordered. A motion was made and seconded to purchase two 60-cup coffee makers. Carried.

August 13th, all church women are invited to Maureen Jackson’s home for a potluck. Please arrive any time after 4:30 p.m. Her address is 132 Riverview Blvd.

The next regular meeting is September 10 at 5 p.m.

Respectfully submitted,
Sandy Harju, Secretary



Music Recommendations

The Afters performed at the ELCA Youth Gathering



After making a name for themselves in the Dallas music scene, the Afters scored a deal with Epic and released their major-label debut in 2005, entitled *I Wish We All Could Win*. The album was a hit on the Christian charts, making it to the Top 25 later that year, while their single "Beautiful Love" landed in the Hot 100 in 2006.

They quickly headed back to the studio to record its follow-up, *Never Going Back to OK*, which saw release in February of 2008. It topped the Christian chart.

The Afters' third album, *Light Up the Sky*, followed in 2010 and reached the Top Ten. They continued their string of Christian Top Ten albums with 2013's *Life Is Beautiful* and 2016's *Live on Forever*, the latter of which marked their first release for Sony's Fair Trade Records.

A greatest-hits collection called *The Beginning & Everything After* appeared in 2019. ~ Chris True

Digital recordings are available on Amazon...



Did you know... If you are a Thrivent member, you can contribute to First Lutheran Church through Thrivent Choice Dollars and Thrivent Actions Teams.

Log into your Thrivent account online, call 1-800-847-4836 or speak with your personal Thrivent representative for more information.

let's be friends



@FIRSTLUTHERANC



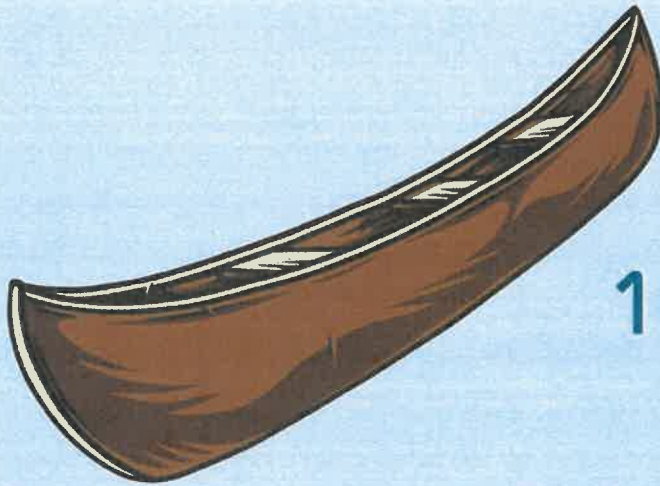
**FIRST LUTHERAN CHURCH
ELCA**

**Beginning in August 18th, worship at
First Evangelical Lutheran Church
will be 11 a.m. Sunday mornings**

**CALLING ALL 6-12TH GRADE
YOUTH AND ADULTS !**

**WE ARE GOING ON A
CANOE DAY TRIP!**

**SAT.
AUGUST
17**



10:00 AM-3:00 PM

**MEET AT FIRST
LUTHERAN CHURCH.
LUNCH, PADDLES PFD'S
AND CANOES INCLUDED!**



LUNCH *
CANOEING*
FRIENDS*
FUN!

**Sign up by Aug 1 with Pastor Christie or in the church
office!**

First Lutheran Youth: What's Up?



July 2024—ELCAYG
Taking a trip to
The Big Easy







To those who helped with worship in July, including: Carol Bass, Brian and Kallie Briggs, Don Nut-hak, Dwayne and Wendy Dougherty, Duayn and Nancy Johnson, and Grace Weisz.

To those who helped with fellowship, including: Ar-del Henrickson, Cynthia Warren, Sherri Mannausau, BettyJeanne Henrickson, Kris Jackson, Kathi Hen-rickson.

To those who helped with music: Kris Jackson, Sue Hewitt, Brad Ettestad, Ryan Skogstad, and Kathy Thureen, and Rachel Hasbargen-Glowack..

Prayer Chain

First Lutheran Church has four active prayer chains. If you have prayer requests for someone, or yourself, call either the church office at 283-2208, or Brenda Bertilson 283-2144; 240-4939. You must have permission to put someone on the chain, either from the person, or from a close relative. To put someone on the list for Sunday prayers, call the office at 283-2208. People will be on the list for one week only, unless you ask that they remain on the list. In that case, please call back when they can be removed.

Remember in your prayers, those in need and those in care facilities.

Good Samaritan: Jackie Christiansen, Margi Roeder, Ruby Radford, Lorraine Nelson, Barb (Strandberg) Wichner

Littlefork Nursing Home: Dick Bergh, Russel Millender

Northwinds Assisted Living: Vicki Freeberg, Terry Lucachick, Henry Carey

Ranier Roost: Ruth Millender

General Fund Financial Information

As of May 31, 2024

Thank you for supporting First Lutheran Church!

	Current Month Actual	Current Month Budget	Variance		Year To Date Actual	Year To Date Budget	Variance
Operating Income	14,621	15,891	(1,270)		83,716	95,346	(11,630)
Operating Expense	14,934	15,891	957		96,062	95,346	(716)
Operating Income Less Ex- pense	(312)	0	(312)		(12,346)	0	(12,346)

August Birthdays

8/2—Betty Bergstrom
Elisha Boelk
Ryan Julien

8/3—Maureen Jackson

8/6—Lynda Tilander
Bryanna Wichner

8/9—Brady Strand

8/10—Paul Golnick
Havyn Pelland
Jackson Reinars
Maci Zaren

8/12—Adrion Mannausau
Teri Zub

8/14—John Cowman
Ronna MacKay

8/15—Brenda Dault
Zach Youso

8/16—Ellen Lindvall
Michael Pelland
Kya Scholler

8/17—Craig Bernath
Greg Harris
Kaeden Rostie

8/18—Knute Boerger
Anthony Cole

8/19—Mikala Hansen

8/20—Marissa Meyer

8/21—Reid Hanson

Lauren Rautio
Christopher Scofield

8/22—George Boe

8/23—Rachel Hasbargen-Glowack

8/25—Carter Jensen
Tammy Lyon

8/27—Thomas Arason

8/28—Stacy Harris
Robert Roeder

8/29—Cassie Thompson
Michelle Trappe

8/30—Tanya Kennedy
Donald Olson

8/31—Timothy MacKay

HAPPY
BIRTHDAY

BACKUS COMMUNITY CAFE SERVES FREE, HOT MEALS TO EVERYONE

**Call 218-283-7225 to reserve meals for you and your family for
dine-in only from 5-6 on Tuesdays and Thursdays.**

There is no charge, but donations are greatly appreciated.

No volunteers were needed due to July 4th celebrations.

We will need volunteers for August and September.

If you are willing to volunteer, please contact the church office.

FIRST EVANGELICAL LUTHERAN CHURCH, ELCA
123 Wayside Lane
International Falls, MN 56649

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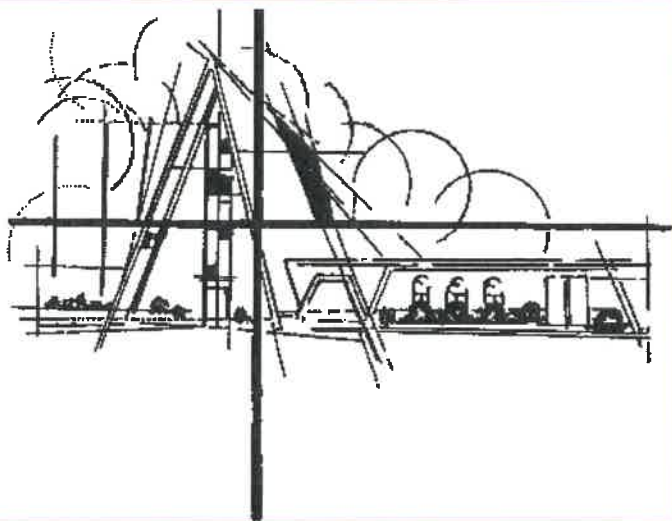
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August 2024
NEWSLETTER



First Evangelical Lutheran Church, ELCA

WHEREVER YOU ARE ON YOUR JOURNEY, YOU ARE WELCOME HERE!



First Lutheran's Mission Statement *Sharing God's Grace*

First Lutheran's Vision Statement
*First Lutheran Church will be a congregation
that shares God's grace by:*

- + Proclaiming the gospel of Jesus Christ with integrity.
- + Welcoming all to active involvement in ministry.
- + Offering a non-judgmental encounter with God through the celebration of liturgical worship with word and sacrament.
- + Responding faithfully to the Great Commission of Matthew 28 -- to grow.
- + Committing ourselves to serving the needs of our congregation and the community at large.

WORSHIP SERVICE
Available on our website
Sundays at 11 a.m.

OFFICE HOURS
Mon. through Thurs., 10 a.m. to 2 p.m.
Office: 218-283-2208

Check out our Website!
www.firstlutheranifalls.org

Look for us on Instagram and Facebook.

AUGUST 2024

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
				1 10 am Clothes Shop 5:00 p.m. Community Cafe	2	3
4 8:00 a.m. Sunrise Worship 10:30 a.m. Worship Pastor Christie leaves for Camp Vermillion/Camp Chaplin	5	6 11 a.m. Bette's Knitters 5 p.m. Community Cafe 5 p.m. Outreach meeting	7	8 5 pm Community Café	9 Pastor Christie returns from Camp Vermillion	10
11 8:00 a.m. Sunrise Worship 10:30 a.m. Worship	12 5 p.m. Ruby's Pantry	13 10:30 a.m. Building & Grounds 5 pm FELW Potluck at Maureen Jackson's 5 p.m. Community Café 5 p.m. Executive Meeting	14 10 a.m. Clothes Drop 5 p.m. Finance	15 10 a.m. Clothes Shop 5 p.m. Community Café 5 p.m. Council Meeting	16	17 10 a.m. Canoe Day Trip
18 9:00 a.m. Worship/Zion Fort Frances 10:00 a.m. Coffee 11:00 a.m. Worship	19 NL Quilters @ 1 p.m.	20 11 a.m. Bette's Knitters 2 p.m. Care Corp 5 p.m. Community Café	21	22 5 p.m. Community Cafe	23	24
25 9:00 a.m. Worship/Zion Fort Frances 10:00 a.m. Coffee 11:00 a.m. Worship	26	27 5 p.m. Community Cafe	28 10 a.m. Clothes Drop	29 10:00 a.m. Clothes Shop 5 p.m. Community Cafe	30	31